Halving Machine



Category: **Food Processing & Kitchen** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Halving machine

What it is used for

To cut suitable food products into two equal or specified portions using a halving machine. To maintain consistent cuts while following hygiene and machine safety procedures.

Main parts

- Machine frame and base
- Cutting blade or halving mechanism
- Product feed tray or guide
- Guard and safety interlock
- Start and stop controls
- Collection tray and drive system

Before you start

1. Read the operating manual and confirm the machine is suitable for the food product.
2. Inspect the blade, feed guide, guards, fasteners, and power connections for damage.
3. Ensure the machine and food-contact surfaces are clean and sanitized as required.
4. Check that the blade and guards are securely installed and safety interlocks work.
5. Prepare food products of suitable size and remove unsuitable hard objects where required.
6. Keep the work area dry, clear, and well lit.

How to use

1. Place the machine on a stable surface and ensure the stop control is accessible.
2. Confirm that the machine is switched off before loading or adjusting parts.
3. Install the correct cutting attachment and adjust the guide according to the product size.
4. Position the collection tray securely below the cutting area.
5. Connect the power supply according to the manufacturer's instructions.
6. Switch on the machine and verify that it runs without unusual noise or vibration.
7. Feed one product at a time using the designated tray or pusher.
8. Keep hands away from the blade and never push products directly by hand into a hazardous cutting zone.
9. Collect the cut portions and check their size and quality.
10. Stop the machine before clearing jams or changing settings.
11. Switch off and isolate power before cleaning or removing the blade.
12. Clean and sanitize food-contact parts according to the approved procedure, then dry them before storage.

⚠ Safety

- Only trained personnel should operate the machine.
- Never bypass guards, interlocks, or other safety devices.
- Keep hands, loose clothing, jewellery, and hair away from moving cutting parts.
- Use only the supplied pusher or feeding tool where required.
- Switch off and disconnect power before clearing a jam or handling the blade.
- Follow food hygiene requirements and use cut-resistant protection only where the risk assessment and manufacturer permit it.

Care & storage

- Clean food residue from the blade, guides, and collection tray after use.
- Inspect the blade for dullness, cracks, or damage before each session.
- Check guards, fasteners, and safety interlocks regularly.
- Lubricate only designated machine parts using suitable food-grade lubricant where required.
- Arrange blade replacement and servicing according to the manual.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Feeding products that exceed the machine's rated size or capacity.
- Pushing food toward the blade with bare hands.
- Operating with loose guards or a damaged blade.
- Clearing a jam while the machine is running or connected to power.
- Skipping cleaning and sanitation between food-processing tasks.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.